**Subject:** RE: Research Weekly Blurb
**Date:** Wednesday, July 8, 2026 at 10:29:42 AM Eastern Daylight Time
**From:** Kate Kennedy
**To:** David Molik

Thanks! We have a smaller edition this week, so I'll add it in.

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**From:** David Molik <molik@ksu.edu>
**Sent:** Wednesday, July 8, 2026 9:16 AM
**To:** Kate Kennedy <kate40@ksu.edu>
**Subject:** Re: Research Weekly Blurb

Kate, I wrote another little blurb that can be included on a slow week:

**From the Library: What actually is Open Access/Open Data?**

Open Access (OA) means that scholarly work is available online without financial, legal, or technical barriers for readers. OA does **not** mean authors give up ownership of their work; rights, reuse, and sharing are still governed by publication agreements and licenses. In practice, there are several routes to Open Access, only one of which incurs an Article Processing Charge (APC): **Gold OA** usually means publishing in a fully open access journal, sometimes with an article processing charge (APC); **Diamond OA** (sometimes **Platinum OA**) is a form of open access where the work is free to read and authors are not charged APCs, often because costs are supported by libraries, universities, scholarly societies, or consortia. Here at K-State, K-State Libraries runs New Prairie Press, a Diamond OA publishing program that supports open access journals, books, textbooks, and conference publications: https://about.newprairiepress.org/; **Green OA** means depositing a version of your work, often the accepted manuscript, in a trusted repository so it can be discovered, read, and preserved even if the final published version remains behind a paywall. At K-State, K-State Research Exchange (K-REx) is the university's institutional repository and is available for Green OA deposit: https://krex.k-state.edu/home.

Open Data is the related idea that research data should be shared in ways that make it findable, accessible, reusable, and appropriately preserved, while still respecting privacy, confidentiality, security, intellectual property, and other legitimate limits. Federal policy is increasingly moving in this direction. The 2022 OSTP public access memo, often called the Nelson Memo, directs federal agencies to make federally funded publications and their supporting data publicly accessible without embargo, and the current OMB-2026-0034 docket includes proposed federal grant rule changes that touch both publication costs and data/evaluation costs. For K-State researchers, the takeaway is: open access and open data expectations are becoming a normal part of the research lifecycle, especially for federally funded work.

K-State Libraries can help you think through which route makes sense, whether that means using an OA publishing agreement, depositing an accepted manuscript in K-REx, publishing through New Prairie Press, or planning for data sharing and preservation earlier in the project:

ope@ksu.edu

**Further Reading**

OpenAccess.nl. (n.d.). *What is open access?* https://www.openaccess.nl/en/about-open-access/what-is-open-access

Nelson, A. (2022). *Ensuring free, immediate, and equitable access to federally funded research*. Office of Science and Technology Policy. https://bidenwhitehouse.archives.gov/wp-content/uploads/2022/08/08-2022-OSTP-Public-Access-Memo.pdf

Office of Management and Budget. (2026). *Regulation for Federal Financial Assistance*. Federal Register. https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2026/05/29/2026-10817/regulation-for-federal-financial-assistance

K-State Libraries. (n.d.). *New Prairie Press*. https://about.newprairiepress.org/

K-State Libraries. (n.d.). *K-State Research Exchange*. https://krex.k-state.edu/home

Best,
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**David Molik (Ph.D.)**
Associate Professor and Librarian
Department Head, Open Publishing Exchange
Kansas State University
molik@ksu.edu | (785-532-5399)
lib.k-state.edu/about/our-people/david-molik/

☐ Book time to meet with me

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**From:** Kate Kennedy <kate40@ksu.edu>
**Date:** Friday, June 12, 2026 at 1:01 PM
**To:** David Molik <molik@ksu.edu>
**Subject:** Re: Research Weekly Blurb

Hi David!

Thanks for sending this my way. I'll include it next week as we should have plenty of space.

Thanks,
Kate

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**From:** David Molik <molik@ksu.edu>
**Sent:** Friday, June 12, 2026 10:43 AM
**To:** Kate Kennedy <kate40@ksu.edu>
**Cc:** Gwen Sibley <grsibley@ksu.edu>
**Subject:** Research Weekly Blurb

Kate,

I've written the following for Research Weekly if you would like to include it, these short blurbs are intended to cover important Scholarly Publishing and Research Library concepts at an approachable and Research PI/Admin level, and I hope to submit a few more over the course of the summer:

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**What is the Serials Crisis?**

From the Open Publishing Exchange, ope@ksu.edu

The serials crisis refers to the long-running mismatch between the rising cost of scholarly journal subscriptions and the budgets universities have available to pay for them. Because journals, databases, and books are essential to research, teaching, grant writing, and publication, libraries have historically worked to absorb steep annual price increases and preserve access for their campuses. Over time, however, subscription costs, especially for bundled "Big Deal" packages from major commercial publishers, have risen faster than library budgets, forcing universities to make difficult choices about what they can sustain. For PIs at K-State, this is not simply a "library budget" problem. It affects what faculty, students, and collaborators can read, cite, teach from, and build on. This is on top of Open Access fees and Article Processing Charges, especially under Hybrid Open Access journals, which means that at an institutional level, publishers charge for both the publication of research, and its access.

K-State Libraries is here to help. Our Content Development team and the Open Publishing Exchange are working on this problem from both directions: negotiating for the best possible access to the scholarly literature while helping K-State researchers share their own work in more open, durable, and visible ways. Here at K-State, common solutions include open access publishing agreements that may reduce or waive article publishing charges for eligible K-State authors, Green Open Access deposit through K-State Research Exchange (K-REx), and Diamond Open Access publishing through New Prairie Press. We are also expanding support for citable research outputs beyond the traditional article, including datasets, code, protocols, workflows, and other research objects. Learn more about K-State's open access agreements at https://lib.k-state.edu/services-support/scholarly-communication/open-access/open-access-agreements/, New Prairie Press at https://about.newprairiepress.org/, and K-REx at https://krex.k-state.edu/home. Each of these services will continue to grow to support K-State research.

**Further Reading**

Thibeault, J. (2026, March 9). *The ever-present library doomsday machine: The story of the ongoing serial crisis and the quest for open access to stop it*. Creative Commons: We Like to Share. https://medium.com/creative-commons-we-like-to-share/the-ever-present-library-doomsday-machine-the-story-of-the-ongoing-serial-crisis-and-the-quest-for-c9fa4b39029e

Bergstrom, T. C., Courant, P. N., McAfee, R. P., & Williams, M. A. (2014). Evaluating big deal journal bundles. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 111*(26), 9425–9430.

https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1403006111
Ancion, Z., Borrell-Damián, L., Mounier, P., Rooryck, J., & Saenen, B. (2022). *Action Plan for Diamond Open Access*. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.6282403

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Best,
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**David Molik (Ph.D.)**
Associate Professor and Librarian
Department Head, Open Publishing Exchange
Kansas State University
molik@ksu.edu | (785-532-5399)
lib.k-state.edu/about/our-people/david-molik/

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